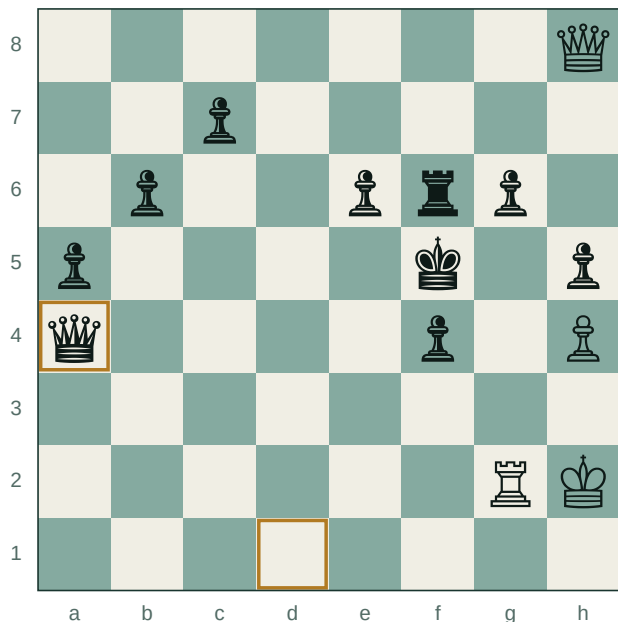


Deflection tactics: White, move 38

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 37...Qxa4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Rg5+ Ke4 39. Qxf6

38.Rg5+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **38...Ke4**.

39.Qxf6 The queen captures the rook on f6.

At the end, nominal material is White 15 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -6 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f5. Geometrically undefended: queen on a4. Check for tactical protection.